

Bicycle

The two-wheeled way to get people MOVING

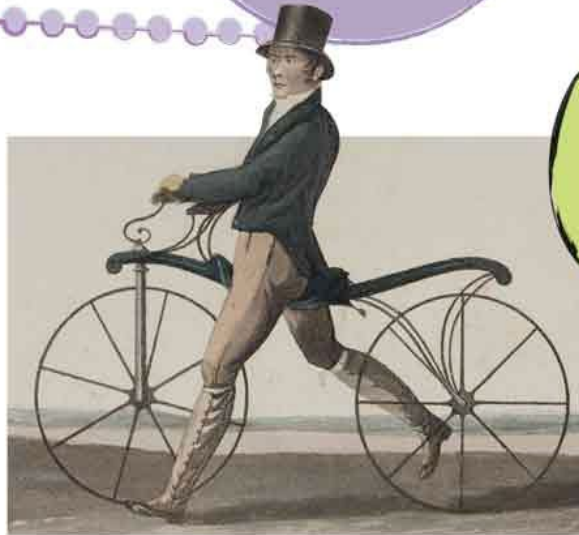
Bicycles started off without pedals, then got too big, but developed into the perfect way to travel.

The rider sat high up over the large front wheel.



Velocipedes

The world's first bicycle was invented in 1818. Known as a **velocipede**, the wooden, **iron-wheeled** machine had a brake but no pedals—it had to be pushed along by the **RIDER'S FEET**. The machine was popular, but only for a few months.



Did you know?

Getting on a high-wheeler was difficult, stopping could be hazardous, and a pothole in the road often meant going headfirst over the handlebars. Ouch!



Pedal power

The first successful **pedal-driven bicycle** was invented by Frenchman Pierre Lallement around 1864. People pedaled around quickly, but very uncomfortably. The bicycles became known as **boneshakers** because their heavy iron frames and iron-rimmed wheels shook over every bump and hole in the road—and back then there were **A LOT OF BUMPS AND HOLES!**

High-wheelers were also called penny-farthings, after two coins of different sizes.



It paved the way for...



German engineer **GOTTLIEB DAIMLER** designed the first **TWO-WHEELED MOTORCYCLE** in 1885, in order to test out a new engine.



BMX, short for bicycle motocross, began in the 1970s as a pedal-power version of **OFF-ROAD MOTORCYCLING**.